

companies that have the capability to supply these to the organisation.

Realising the immense options opening up with modifying government policies and tenders, domestic companies that made only small parts have started developing in-house capabilities. While a large number of foreign companies have already made their presence in this space, Indian giants like Tata Motors, Larsen & Toubro, Bharat Forge and Ashok Leyland are also trying to get established in this domain. The government is committed to cutting down on imports for two reasons—import is expensive, and the products and systems are really strategic in nature.

Many of the PSUs lack the capability to serve this huge demand. For instance, Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL) does not have design capabilities and does licensed production, but only HAL has aerospace capabilities. This creates a lot of space for the private companies to step into.

As already mentioned, the maintenance,

State initiatives by Karnataka

Almost 70% of aerospace operations are based in Karnataka. Perhaps this is what helped Karnataka to drive itself and become the first in India to come out with an aerospace policy, which was inaugurated by the then defence minister A.K. Antony in 2013. The state plans to attract investment of ₹ 600 billion over the next 10-year period in two phases, i.e., 2013-18 and 2018-2023.

"This policy went off to quick implementation, and was released immediately after the inaugural function. It includes incentives for the aerospace sector, and formation of an aerospace park stretching 938 acres. Presently, not only has it been set up, 47 units have already been allotted in India. Two companies, Wipro and Swiss-German group Stargar, have completed setting up the infrastructure and even started production. Of the remaining 45, five firms have started construction, while the rest 40 are mobilising resources," explained M.N. Vidyashankar, president, India Electronics & Semiconductor Association (IESA).

Currently, there is also a proposal to set up common facilities like Centre of Excellence (CoE), which can train people required by the aerospace sector. To ensure that this doesn't get concentrated in Bengaluru, training is also going to be done in north Karnataka in Hubli.

Supporting organisation

Defence Electronics Manufacturers' Association (DEMA) is an organisation that was formed by 38 small and medium enterprises in and around Pune region that manufacture and/or supply defence-related products. Founded under the leadership of late admiral Mudholkar in 1989, the association now covers defence-related organisations and government departments like the DRDO, defence production units, PSUs in defence (HAL, BEL, etc) and the Directorate General of Service Tax and Directorate General of Quality Assurance.

repair and overhaul (MRO) for aerospace and defence equipment is a big opportunity for private firms and

OEMs. Most major equipment remains in service for two to three decades. Though the potential for MROs is

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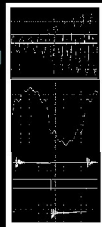
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